



BUT I SAY TO YOU!

When Knowledge Reaches the Heart

MATTHEW 5:21–22, 38–44 • ACTS 2:37–41

5–7
MINUTES**MAIN
IDEA**

They knew **WHAT** God commanded.
Jesus taught them **WHY** God commanded it.

1 THEY KNEW THE COMMAND *Matthew 5:21–22***A. The command they knew.***“You shall not murder.” (v. 21)*

- They had been taught the rule.
- Someone could say, “I’ve never murdered anyone. I’m good.”
- Outward obedience does not always mean the heart is right with God.

B. Jesus goes deeper.*“But I say to you that whoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment.” (v. 22)*

- Jesus moves from the action to the attitude.
- Murder is the fruit; anger, hatred, and contempt are roots.
- The command regulated the hands; Jesus pointed to the heart.

**KEY
TRUTH**

God doesn’t merely want compliance.
He wants the person.

2 “AN EYE FOR AN EYE” *Matthew 5:38–44***A. The rule they knew.***“An eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth.” (v. 38)*

- This limited punishment and restrained revenge.
- It prevented people from taking justice into their own hands.
- It was a rule about fairness, not uncontrolled retaliation.

B. The heart problem.

- Man’s response: *“They did it to me first!”*
- It is easy to want to get even.
- The rule can be kept outwardly while bitterness, hatred, and revenge remain in the heart.

C. Jesus’ higher call.*“But I say to you... love your enemies, bless those who curse you...” (vv. 39, 44)*

- Jesus goes beyond knowing the rule.
- He calls for a transformed heart that shows mercy.
- Knowing the rule does not mean possessing the heart God intended.

**THE
PRINCIPLE****KNOWLEDGE + HEART → OBEDIENT RESPONSE***You can know what God says without yet having decided that you want to belong completely to Him.***3** WHAT DOES THIS MEAN FOR BAPTISM? *Acts 2:37–41***A. They heard the truth.**

- Peter preached Jesus—who He is, what sin does, and what He has done.

B. They were convicted.*“Now when they heard this, they were cut to the heart...” (v. 37)*

- They understood—and it reached their hearts.
- Knowledge met conviction.

C. They responded.*“Men and brethren, what shall we do?” (v. 37)**“Repent, and let every one of you be baptized...” (v. 38)*

- They didn’t wait for a certain age.
- They responded because they understood and wanted to belong to Christ.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR US**A. There is no biblical “baptism age.”**

- Not 13. Not 17. Not any predetermined birthday.
- The Bible never gives a specific age for baptism.

B. Knowledge is essential.

- You must understand who Jesus is.
- You must understand sin, the cross, repentance, and what you are doing when you are baptized.

C. But knowledge alone is not enough.

- A person can know all the right answers and still not be ready.
- Genuine baptism flows from a heart that wants Christ—either through love for Him or a godly fear of sin.

D. Key questions for your heart.

- Do I understand what the Bible teaches?
- Do I believe it?
- Has that truth reached my heart?
- Do I truly want to belong to Christ?

**THE
INVITATION****BAPTISM IS NOT ABOUT REACHING THE RIGHT AGE.**

*It is about reaching the point where the truth you understand
reaches your heart and demands a response.*